

Using Windows Troubleshooter to Fix a Printer Showing "Offline"

1. **Open Windows Settings**
 - Click the **Start** button and select **Settings**.
 - Go to **Update & Security** → **Troubleshoot** → **Additional Troubleshooters** (or **System** → **Troubleshoot** in newer versions of Windows).
2. **Select the Printer Troubleshooter**
 - Find **Printer** in the list of troubleshooters.
 - Click **Run the troubleshooter**.
3. **Choose the Problem Printer**
 - Windows will display a list of installed printers.
 - Select the printer showing **Offline** status and click **Next**.
4. **Allow Windows to Diagnose the Issue**
 - The troubleshooter checks for common problems such as:
 - Printer connectivity issues
 - Incorrect printer settings
 - Print spooler service problems
 - Driver issues
 - Printer being set as offline accidentally
5. **Review the Results**
 - The troubleshooter displays the issues it finds and indicates whether they were fixed automatically.
 - If a problem is detected, Windows may provide a "**Apply this fix**" option.
6. **Apply Recommended Fixes**
 - Follow any on-screen instructions.
 - Windows may restart services, set the printer as the default printer, or reconnect the printer.
7. **Test the Printer**
 - After troubleshooting is complete, print a test page to verify that the printer is now online and working.

Information Provided by the Troubleshooter

During the process, the Windows Troubleshooter typically provides:

- The name of the printer being checked.
- A progress report showing the diagnostic tests being performed.
- Details of any problems found (for example, "Print Spooler service is not running").
- Whether the issue was **fixed**, **not fixed**, or **requires user action**.
- Recommendations for additional troubleshooting if the problem remains unresolved.

Example Outcome

Problem Found: Printer is set to offline mode.

Status: Fixed.

Action Taken: Windows changed the printer status to online and restarted the print spooler service.